

NATASHA NAYAK

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Engineering-trained Operations Excellence leader with an MBA and \$10M+ in documented manufacturing savings. Drives Total Quality Management, Root Cause Problem Solving, Line Balancing, and digital process adoption across fast-paced environments. Proven change leader in Continuous Improvement rollouts, frontline capability building, and sustainable waste reduction.

EDUCATION

Simon Business School, University of Rochester
Master of Business Administration - Strategy, Analytics & Operations

Rochester, NY
Aug 2024 - May 2026

- GPA: 3.8/4.0; Forté Fellow, Dean's List, Beta Gamma Sigma

College of Engineering Pune, University of Pune
Bachelor of Technology - Metallurgy and Materials Science Engineering

Pune, India
Aug 2016 - Oct 2020

- GPA: 3.6/4.0; Honors in Metallurgical Engineering

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

The Ship Group (Behavioral Health and Community Services)

Charlotte, NC

Business Operations & Program Development Intern

Jun 2025 - Aug 2025

- Increased throughput by 60% and accelerated \$1.7M in revenue realization by reengineering compliance workflows, auditing 1,400+ records, and clearing 870+ backlog cases through end-to-end process redesign
- Saved 120 staff hours weekly and reduced case turnaround time by 22% by deploying Tableau dashboards to identify bottlenecks and drive targeted process improvements across 3 departments

Mahindra First Choice Wheels Limited (Automotive Retail)

Mumbai, India

Senior Executive, Strategy & Operations

Sep 2023 - May 2024

- Built the post-merger Operations Excellence function from scratch, aligning procurement, sales, finance, and technology teams to deliver 30% faster execution and \$2.5M in synergy savings
- Reduced operational inefficiencies by 22% and improved quality metrics by 18% after evaluating 150+ KPIs across 11 verticals and implementing Total Quality Management (TQM)-driven process improvements

Ventures World LLP (Digital Sports Startup)

Mumbai, India

Senior Manager, Business Operations & Analytics

Apr 2022 - Aug 2023

- Eliminated manual reporting by building AI-assisted real-time analytics systems across Business Intelligence (BI) tools, reducing report generation from 6+ hours to under 1 hour and enabling data-driven decisions across 35+ stakeholders

JSW Steel Dolvi Works (Global Steel Manufacturer)

Maharashtra, India

Assistant Manager, Operations Excellence

Nov 2020 - Apr 2022

- Delivered \$10.3M in FY22 savings across 10,530+ Kaizens, 800+ QCC projects, and 200+ process improvements, improving Overall Equipment Effectiveness by 6 points while leading brownfield expansion from 5 to 10 MTPA
- Reduced grade changeover time from 4+ hours to under 1 hour by facilitating SMED and DMAIC workshops to redesign sequences and standardize internal/external task separation, recovering 28 production hours monthly
- Cut line defect rate from 18% to 4% by conducting Gemba Walks and applying 5 Whys Root Cause Analysis to identify a conveyor scale defect, rebalancing production flow and eliminating recurring failures through plant-wide SOP
- Improved safety audit scores by 7 points through 5S and PDCA practices, driving national TQM portal rollout across all JSW plants by overcoming frontline resistance through incentives and competitions

PROJECT EXPERIENCE

Thermo Fisher Scientific (*Lead Consultant, Strategy & Operations*)

Jan 2025 - May 2025

- Standardized licensing and renewal workflows by designing cross-functional Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) and end-to-end ticketing processes, improving operational efficiency and supporting \$14M in incremental recurring revenue

Mahindra CIE Automotive (*Engineering Project, Manufacturing Quality*)

May 2019 - Aug 2019

- Reduced steel billet rework rate by 15% and delivered \$1.2M in annualized savings by implementing Ultrasonic Testing inspections to detect defects earlier in the production line and eliminate downstream waste

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

- CI Methodologies:** Kaizen, DMAIC, SMED, Gemba Walks, 5 Whys, RCA, 5S, Line Balancing, PDCA, TQM, QCC
- Technical Tools:** Advanced Excel, Power BI, Tableau, SQL, SAP, Salesforce, Bizagi, Python
- Skills:** Operations Excellence, Manufacturing Transformation, Change Management, Digital Process Adoption, Cross-Functional Leadership, Supply Chain Optimization, Cost Optimization, Program Management, Risk Management
- Interests:** Trained Classical Dancer, Avid Traveler, Deep-Sea Diver